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The Living World

NEET Biology · Previous Year Questions with Answer Key

38	25	1988 – 2026	English
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MCQ (Single Correct Answer)	38 questions
Answer key	at the end

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MCQ (Single Correct Answer) 38 questions

Q1. RE-NEET 2026

Genus represents ____ .

(A) a group of closely related families
(B) an individual plant or animal
(C) a population of plants and animals
(D) a group of closely related species

Open solution

Q2. RE-NEET 2026

Arrange the following taxonomic categories in ascending order.

(a) Genus
(b) Class
(c) Order
(d) Phylum
(e) Family
(f) Kingdom
(g) Species

Choose the correct answer from the options given below :

(A) (f), (c), (b), (g), (d), (e), (a)
(B) (g), (a), (e), (c), (b), (d), (f)
(C) (a), (c), (d), (g), (f), (b), (e)
(D) (g), (c), (d), (b), (e), (a), (f)

Open solution

Q3. RE-NEET 2026

Match List-I with List-II.

	List-I		List-II
A.	Family	I.	Sapindales
B.	Genus	II.	Dicotyledonae
C.	Class	III.	Anacardiaceae
D.	Phylum	IV.	Angiospermae
E.	Order	V.	Mangifera

Choose the correct answer from the options given below :

(A) A-III, B-V, C-II, D-IV, E-I
(B) A-I, B-V, C-II, D-IV, E-III
(C) A-II, B-I, C-III, D-IV, E-V
(D) A-II, B-III, C-V, D-I, E-IV

Open solution

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Q4. NEET 2026

Which one of the following statements is not true about the universal rules of binomial nomenclature?

(A) Biological names are generally in Latin

(B) Both the words in a biological name, when handwritten, are separately underlined or printed in italics

(C) The specific epithet in the biological name starts with a small letter

(D) The first word in the biological name represents the specific epithet, while the second component denotes the genus

Open solution

Q5. NEET 2022 Phase 2

Which of the following are true about the taxonomical aid 'key'?

(a) Keys are based on the similarities and dissimilarities.

(b) Key is analytical in nature.

(c) Keys are based on the contrasting characters in pair called couplet.

(d) Same key can be used for all taxonomic categories.

(e) Each statement in the key is called Lead.

Choose the most appropriate answer from the options given below:

(A) (a), (c), (d) and (e) only

(B) (a), (b) and (c) only

(C) (b), (c), and (d) only

(D) (a), (b), (c) and (e) only

Open solution

Q6. NEET 2022 Phase 1

In the taxonomic categories which hierarchical arrangement in ascending order is correct in case of animals?

(A) Kingdom, Phylum, Class, Order, Family, Genus, Species

(B) Kingdom, Class, Phylum, Family, Order, Genus, Species

(C) Kingdom, Order, Class, Phylum, Family, Genus, Species

(D) Kingdom, Order, Phylum, Class, Family, Genus, Species

Open solution

Q7. NEET 2021

Which one of the following belongs to the family Muscidae?

(A) House fly

(B) Fire fly

(C) Grasshopper

(D) Cockroach

Open solution

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Q8. NEET 2019 (Odisha)

Which of the following is against the rules of ICBN?

(A) Generic and specific names should be written starting with small letters.

(B) Hand written scientific names should be underlined.

(C) Every species should have a generic name and a specific epithet.

(D) Scientific names are in Latin and should be italized.

Open solution

Q9. NEET 2019 (Odisha)

The contrasting characteristics generally in a pair used for identification of animals in Taxonomic Key are referred to as:

(A) Alternate (B) Lead (C) Couplet (D) Doublet

Open solution

Q10. NEET 2019

Select the **correctly** written scientific name of Mango which was first described by Carolus Linnaeus :

(A) *Mangifera indica*

(B) *Mangifera Indica*

(C) *Mangifera indica* Car. Linn.

(D) *Mangifera indica* Linn.

Open solution

Q11. NEET 2018

Match the items given in column I with those in column II and select the correct option given below.

Column I	Column II
A. Herbarium	(i) It is a place having a collection of preserved plants and animals.
B. Key	(ii) A list that enumerates methodically all the species found in an area with brief description aiding identification.
C. Museum	(iii) Is a place where dried and pressed plant specimens mounted on sheets are kept.
D. Catalogue	(iv) A booklet containing a list of characters and their alternates which are helpful in identification of various taxa.

(A) A → (ii), B → (iv), C → (iii), D → (i)

(B) A → (iii), B → (ii), C → (i), D → (iv)

(C) A → (iii), B → (iv), C → (i), D → (ii)

(D) A → (i), B → (iv), C → (iii), D → (ii)

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Q12. NEET 2016 Phase 2

The label of a herbarium sheet does not carry information on

(A) date of collection
(B) name of collector
(C) local names
(D) height of the plant.

Open solution

Q13. NEET 2016 Phase 2

Study the four statements (A-D) given below and select the two correct ones out of them.

A. Definition of biological species was given by Ernst Mayr.
B. Photoperiod does not affect reproduction in plants.
C. Binomial nomenclature system was given by R.H. Whittaker.
D. In unicellular organisms, reproduction is synonymous with growth.

The two correct statements are

(A) B and C
(B) C and D
(C) A and D
(D) A and B

Open solution

Q14. NEET 2016 Phase 1

Nomenclature is governed by certain universal rules. Which one of the following is contrary to the rules of nomenclature?

(A) The names are written in Latin and are italicised.
(B) When written by hand the names are to be underlined.
(C) Biological names can be written in any language.
(D) The first word in a biological name represents the genus name and the second is a specific epithet.

Open solution

Q15. NEET 2013 (Karnataka)

The common characteristics between tomato and potato will be maximum at the level of their

(A) family
(B) order
(C) division
(D) genus.

Open solution

Q16. NEET 2013

Which one of the following is not a correct statement?

(A) A museum has collection of photographs of plants and animals.
(B) Key is taxonomic aid for identification of specimens.
(C) Herbarium houses dried, pressed and preserved plant specimens.
(D) Botanical gardens have collection of living plants for reference.

Open solution

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Q17. AIPMT 2012 Mains

Which one of the following organisms is scientifically correctly named, correctly printed according to the international Rules of Nomenclature and correctly described?

(A) *Musca domestica* - the common house lizard, a reptile

(B) *Plasmodium falciparum* - a protozoan pathogen causing the most serious type of malaria.

(C) *Felis tigris* - the Indian tiger, well protected in Gir forests.

(D) *E.coli* - full name *Entamoeba coli,* a commonly occurring bacterium in human intestine.

Open solution

Q18. AIPMT 2011 Mains

Which one of the following aspects is an exclusive characteristic of living things?

(A) Isolated metabolic reactions occur in *vitro*

(B) Increase in mass from inside only

(C) Perception of events happening in the environment and their memory.

(D) Increase in mass by accumulation of material both on surface as well as internally.

Open solution

Q19. AIPMT 2011 Prelims

Which one of the following animals is correctly matched with its particular taxonomic category?

(A) Tiger - *tigris,* species

(B) Cuttlefish - mollusca, class

(C) Humans - primata, family

(D) Housefly - *Musca,* order

Open solution

Q20. AIPMT 2007

ICBN stands for

(A) International Code of Botanical Nomenclature

(B) International Congress of Biological Names

(C) Indian Code of Botanical Nomenclature

(D) Indian Congress of Biological Names.

Open solution

Q21. AIPMT 2007

The living organisms can be unexceptionally distinguished from the non-living things on the basis of their ability for

(A) interaction with the environment and progressive evolution

(B) reproduction

(C) growth and movement

(D) responsiveness to touch.

Open solution

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Q22. AIPMT 2005

One of the most important functions of botanical gardens is that

(A) they provide a beautiful area for recreation

(B) one can observe tropical plants there

(C) they allow *ex situ* conservation of germplasm

(D) they provide the natural habitat for wild life.

Open solution

Q23. AIPMT 2003

Species are considered as

(A) real basic units of classification

(B) the lowest units of classification

(C) artificial concept of human mind which cannot be defined in absolute terms

(D) real units of classification devised by taxonomists.

Open solution

Q24. AIPMT 2003

Biosystematics aims at

(A) the classification of organisms based on broad morphological characters

(B) delimiting various taxa of organisms and establishing their relationships

(C) the classification of organisms based on their evolutionary history and establishing their phylogeny on the totality of various parameters from all fields of studies

(D) identification and arrangement of organisms on the basis of their cytological characteristics.

Open solution

Q25. AIPMT 2001

Which of the following is less general in characters as compared to genus?

(A) Species (B) Division (C) Class (D) Family

Open solution

Q26. AIPMT 1996

'Taxon' is the unit of a group of

(A) order (B) taxonomy (C) species (D) genes

Open solution

Q27. AIPMT 1993

Linnaeus is credited with

(A) binomial nomenclature (B) theory of biogenesis

(C) discovery of microscope (D) discovery of blood circulation

Open solution

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Q28. AIPMT 1993

Gorilla, chimpanzee, monkeys and humans belong to the same

(A) species (B) genus (C) family (D) order

Open solution

Q29. AIPMT 1992

Sequence of taxonomic categories is

(A) class–phylum–tribe–order–family–genus–species

(B) division–class–family–tribe–order–genus–species

(C) division–class–order–family–tribe–genus–species

(D) phylum–order–class–tribe–family–genus–species

Open solution

Q30. AIPMT 1992

The term phylum was given by

(A) Cuvier (B) Haeckel (C) Theophrastus (D) Linnaeus

Open solution

Q31. AIPMT 1992

A group of plants or animals with similar traits of any rank is

(A) species (B) genus (C) order (D) taxon

Open solution

Q32. AIPMT 1992

A taxon is

(A) a group of related families (B) a group of related species

(C) a type of living organisms (D) a taxonomic group of any ranking

Open solution

Q33. AIPMT 1991

A group of plants or animals with similar traits of any rank is

(A) species (B) genus (C) order (D) taxon

Open solution

Q34. AIPMT 1990

A taxon is

(A) a group of related families (B) a group of related species

(C) a type of living organisms (D) a taxonomic group of any ranking

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Q35. AIPMT 1990

Basic unit or smallest taxon of taxonomy/classification is

(A) species (B) kingdom (C) family (D) variety

Open solution

Q36. AIPMT 1990

Linnaeus evolved a system of nomenclature called

(A) mononomial (B) vernacular (C) binomial (D) polynomial

Open solution

Q37. AIPMT 1988

The term “New Systematics” was introduced by

(A) Bentham and Hooker (B) Linnaeus

(C) Julian Huxley (D) A.P. de Candolle

Open solution

Q38. AIPMT 1988

Static concept of species was put forward by

(A) de Candolle (B) Linnaeus (C) Theophrastus (D) Darwin

Open solution

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Answer Key

1. **D**	2. **B**	3. **A**	4. **D**	5. **D**
6. **A**	7. **A**	8. **A**	9. **C**	10. **D**
11. **C**	12. **D**	13. **C**	14. **C**	15. **A**
16. **A**	17. **B**	18. **C**	19. **A**	20. **A**
21. **A**	22. **C**	23. **A**	24. **C**	25. **A**
26. **B**	27. **A**	28. **D**	29. **C**	30. **B**
31. **D**	32. **D**	33. **D**	34. **D**	35. **A**
36. **C**	37. **C**	38. **B**		

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